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## INTERVIEWS

## The rapid rise of sustainable warehousing and what it means for the industry

Warehouser's commitment to innovation positions it for sustained leadership as it embraces evolving industry trends.

by Staff Writer | November 26, 2024

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Sandeep Chadha, Founder & CEO – Warehouser

The industrial warehousing sector is undergoing a significant transformation driven by automation, sustainability, and the rapid growth of e-commerce. Companies like Warehouser are adopting cutting-edge technologies such as robotics, AI, and sustainable practices to improve operational efficiency, reduce carbon emissions, and cater to rising consumer demand.

As warehousing adapts to the demands of e-commerce logistics, location strategy and expansion into emerging markets become crucial. The future promises a smarter, more sustainable warehousing landscape, where innovation and scalability will define industry leadership.

In this interview, **Sandeep Chadha, Founder & CEO of Warehouser**, discusses the company's approach to these evolving trends and their strategic vision for the future of warehousing.

### What key trends do you see shaping the industrial warehousing sector in 2024 and beyond?

In 2024 and beyond, the warehousing sector will be heavily influenced by automation, sustainability, and the rapid rise of e-commerce. We're seeing a shift towards intelligent warehousing solutions that leverage IoT and data analytics to enhance efficiency and real-time inventory management. Moreover, as sustainability becomes a global priority, there's a growing demand for eco-friendly warehouse operations, including energy-efficient buildings and reduced emissions through optimised logistics. The increasing importance of omnichannel retail will also drive demand for more agile and flexible supply chains. These trends are pushing the boundaries of traditional warehousing, and those who adapt will stay ahead of the curve.

**How is technology, particularly automation and robotics, transforming warehousing operations, and what advancements is Warehouser integrating?**

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Automation and robotics are game-changers in warehousing, enabling greater precision, speed, and scalability. At Warehouser, we've embraced this by deploying robotics for inventory picking and sorting, as well as automated guided vehicles (AGVs) that move products efficiently across our facilities. Additionally, our warehouse management systems (WMS) are integrated with AI, allowing us to manage stock levels and order processing with a high degree of accuracy. The goal is to reduce manual tasks and improve operational efficiency, which, in turn, helps us deliver better service to our clients.

**How is Warehouser incorporating eco-friendly practices in its operations, and are there any specific sustainability initiatives you're leveraging?**

Sustainability is a core element of our strategy. We've taken steps to make our operations more eco-friendly by adopting solar energy solutions, implementing energy-efficient lighting systems, and optimising waste management practices. One initiative we're particularly proud of is our focus on reducing carbon emissions in transportation through route optimisation software, which lowers fuel consumption. Additionally, we're exploring the use of recyclable and biodegradable packaging materials to support our clients' green goals. Sustainability is no longer optional in warehousing; it's a necessity, and we are committed to leading by example.

**How has Warehouser adapted to the surge in e-commerce-driven logistics, and what challenges and opportunities does this present?**

The surge in e-commerce has forced a rethink of how warehouses operate. To keep up, Warehouser has expanded our fulfilment capabilities and invested in cutting-edge technology to manage higher order volumes with shorter turnaround times. This shift has presented challenges, such as handling peak demand efficiently and maintaining real-time inventory visibility. But it also opens doors to new opportunities—such as last-mile delivery optimisations and micro-fulfilment strategies—ensuring that we can serve both large enterprises and smaller retailers looking to scale.

**How does Warehouser approach selecting optimal locations for new facilities, and where do you see strong demand growth?**

Location is a key factor in delivering seamless warehousing services. Our strategy focuses on proximity to major highways, ports, and urban centres to reduce transit times and costs. We also analyse market trends, regional demand, and local infrastructure. Currently, we see demand growing strongly in Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities as e-commerce continues to penetrate these markets. Expanding into these areas allows us to support the rising need for efficient storage and distribution networks closer to consumers.

**Can you share Warehouser's expansion plans for the next few years, and what markets or sectors are you targeting for growth?**

Looking ahead, Warehouser plans to scale both domestically and internationally. We're keen to expand our reach in industries such as FMCG, Industrial, Automobile, pharmaceuticals, and e-commerce, which are seeing robust growth. In terms of geographical expansion, we are targeting regions with increasing industrial activity and strong economic growth. Our goal is to provide customised, scalable solutions that cater to the diverse needs of these industries. At the same time, we're committed to strengthening our technological capabilities to stay at the forefront of innovation in warehousing.

**What are the biggest challenges the industrial warehousing sector currently faces, and how is Warehouser addressing them?**

The sector faces multiple challenges, from rising real estate costs to labour shortages and increasing customer expectations. To tackle these, our clients are leveraging automation to reduce dependency on labour and to maximise space utilisation in our facilities. We're also closely collaborating with logistics partners to ensure smooth operations, especially in last-mile delivery, where speed and accuracy are critical. Additionally, we are focused on building sustainable operations to meet growing regulatory and environmental pressures.

**What's your vision for the future of industrial warehousing in India, and how do you see Warehouser evolving to maintain a leadership position?**

Our vision for the future of industrial warehousing in India is one of smart, sustainable, and scalable growth. We anticipate that warehousing will evolve into a fully integrated, data-driven ecosystem where technology and sustainability go hand in hand. At Warehouser, we aim to lead this transformation by continually investing in automation, enhancing our sustainability practices, and building tailored solutions

for our clients. As the market grows and evolves, we are confident that our forward-thinking approach will keep us at the forefront of the industry.

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